

The "Elephant" Framework: Ownership & Execution

1. Visualize the Elephant (Kanban)

"First, I wouldn't let the elephant roam free in my head where it causes anxiety. I would 'stable' it by breaking it down into its smallest, most manageable parts. In a **Kanban** system, this means identifying every dependency—feeding, housing, medical care—and turning those into discrete, visible tasks. By visualizing the entire 'elephant' on a board, I can see the scope clearly and ensure nothing is overlooked."

2. Control the Intake (Pull)

"The biggest mistake with an elephant-sized project is trying to do everything at once. I would implement a **Pull system** with a strict **Work-In-Progress (WIP) limit**. I can't feed the elephant, wash it, and train it at the exact same second. I would only 'pull' the next most critical task into my active work lane once the previous one is finished. This prevents me from being overwhelmed and ensures that every action I take is high-quality and completed, rather than having five things half-done."

3. Establish a Rhythm (Flow)

"Finally, I would focus on **Flow**. I'd look for the 'bottlenecks'—is the water bucket too small? Is the food delivery late? By identifying and removing these friction points, I create a steady, repeatable cadence. Over time, looking after the elephant isn't a series of crises; it becomes a streamlined process. You eat the elephant one bite at a time, but you do it with a rhythm that ensures you don't burn out before the job is done."

Key Interview Takeaways to Emphasize:

- **Ownership:** You didn't try to get rid of it; you accepted the responsibility.
- **Decomposition:** You turned a "problem" into a "process."
- **Sustainability:** Your mention of WIP limits shows you understand how to manage resources without crashing.

Summary Table for Your Interview Prep

Elephant Analogy	Project Management Principle	Why it matters to the Interviewer
Mapping the Elephant	Kanban (Visualization)	Shows you can organize complex data.
One Task at a Time	Pull (WIP Limits)	Shows you prioritize and finish what you start.
Steady Movement	Flow (Optimization)	Shows you build efficient, long-term systems.